# Public Access, Fishing and Boating Rules for the Huai Sop Khong Small Hydropower Dam

Sop Khong Hydro Co., Ltd., Mae Chaem, Chiang Mai · Policy SKH-POL-07, version 3 · Effective 1 July 2026

## 1. Purpose and scope

The Huai Sop Khong Small Hydropower Dam sits on the Huai Sop Khong stream about 9 km north-west of Mae Chaem town. Water levels near the dam can change quickly and without visible warning. These rules apply to every visitor, permit holder and member of the public who enters land or water managed by Sop Khong Hydro Co., Ltd. (the "Company"). They replace version 2 of this policy dated 1 March 2024.

## 2. Access zones

The site is divided into four zones, marked with coloured signs.

- **Zone A, Restricted (red signs):** the dam crest, intake, spillway gates, powerhouse yard and the stream bed down to 150 m below the powerhouse outlet. No public access except on a guided tour (section 7).
- **Zone B, Headpond Recreation Zone (green signs):** the reservoir upstream of the yellow buoy line, 200 m from the dam crest.
- **Zone C, Downstream Reach (blue signs):** the stream from 150 m below the powerhouse outlet to the Ban Sop Khong suspension bridge, a distance of about 2.4 km.
- **Visitor Area (white signs):** the car park, the Visitor Centre and the public viewing platform.

## 3. Opening hours

The Visitor Area is open daily from 07:00 to 18:00, including public holidays. Until 30 June 2026 it opened from 08:00 to 17:00; the longer hours apply from 1 July 2026. The viewing platform is closed while any spillway gate is moving.

Boating in Zone B is allowed from 08:00 to 17:00 during the dry season, 1 November to 31 May. Boating is not allowed at all from 1 June to 31 October. Fishing from the bank in Zones B and C is allowed from sunrise to sunset all year, subject to the closed season in section 5.

## 4. Warning signals and water releases

Turbine start-ups, spillway gate openings and sediment flushing can raise the water level in Zone C from about 0.6 m to 1.8 m within 20 minutes. Everyone in Zones B and C must obey the following siren signals.

- **Two long blasts:** a turbine will start in 15 minutes. Move out of the stream bed in Zone C and stay on the bank.
- **Three long blasts of 10 seconds each, repeated after 5 minutes:** a spillway gate opening or sediment flushing will begin in 30 minutes. Leave the water and the stream banks in Zone C and

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move at least 5 m above the water line.

- **One continuous tone lasting one minute:** emergency. Leave Zones B and C immediately and go to higher ground.

Amber lights flash at the four warning stations for as long as a release is in progress. While an amber light is flashing, nobody may enter the water in Zone C for any reason.

Scheduled sediment flushing takes place on the first Wednesday of each month from November to May, between 09:00 and 13:00. Anyone may receive free text alerts before every planned release by registering at the Visitor Centre or by sending the word JOIN to 08 1745 2290.

> **Note.** Unplanned releases can happen at any time during heavy rain. The sirens and amber lights, not text alerts, are the official warning.

## 5. Fishing

### 5.1 Permits

Every angler aged 12 or over needs a valid Company fishing permit, which covers both Zone B and Zone C. An annual permit costs 300 baht per calendar year for residents of Mae Chaem district and 900 baht for all other anglers. A day permit costs 80 baht and is valid until sunset on the day of issue. Children under 12 may fish without a permit next to an adult permit holder.

### 5.2 How to obtain an annual permit

1. Come in person to the Permit Desk in Room 2 of the Visitor Centre, open Monday to Saturday from 08:30 to 16:00. Online applications are not accepted.
2. Bring your Thai national ID card or passport. Residents claiming the resident rate must also bring their house registration document.
3. Complete application form SK-F1, attach one passport-size photograph and sign the safety declaration on its back.
4. Pay the fee in cash or by QR payment. The permit card is issued on the same day and must be carried whenever you fish.

Day permits are also sold at the car park kiosk on Sundays from 07:00 to 12:00.

### 5.3 Fishing rules

- Rod and line only, with a maximum of two rods per angler. Nets, traps, spears, explosives and electric fishing are forbidden in all zones.
- Daily catch limit: five fish per permit holder. Fish shorter than 25 cm must be returned to the water alive.
- Closed season in Zone C: from 16 May to 15 August no fishing of any kind is allowed in Zone C, to protect spawning fish. Fishing in Zone B continues during this period.

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## 6. Boating and swimming

Only non-motorised craft, such as kayaks, canoes and stand-up paddle boards, may be used in Zone B. Every person on the water must wear a buoyant life jacket, and every craft must be signed in and out in the boat log at the launching ramp. No more than 10 craft may be on the water at the same time.

Swimming is not allowed in Zones A and B. In Zone C, swimming is allowed only at Kaeng Hin Lai beach, between 10:00 and 16:00, and only when the amber light at the beach is not flashing. Children under 14 must be accompanied in the water by an adult.

## 7. Group visits and powerhouse tours

Guided tours of the powerhouse and dam crest run from Tuesday to Saturday at 10:00 and 14:00. No tours are held on public holidays. A tour group may have up to 20 people. Groups must book at least 7 working days in advance through the Community Relations Office (telephone 053 828 410).

- Visitors must be at least 10 years old to enter the turbine hall and must wear closed-toe shoes. Groups with visitors under 15 need one adult supervisor for every 10 young visitors.
- Tours are free for schools located in Chiang Mai province. All other visitors pay 50 baht per person.
- Tours are cancelled without charge when the reservoir level is above 412.5 m above mean sea level (flood watch).

## 8. Drones and camping

Drones may not be flown within 500 m of the dam crest unless the Plant Manager has given written permission at least 5 working days before the flight. Camping and open fires are not allowed on Company land.

## 9. Breaches and penalties

- **First breach:** a written warning and removal from the site for the day.
- **Second breach within 12 months:** the fishing permit is suspended for 6 months without refund.
- **Serious breach** (entering Zone A without a guide, crossing the yellow buoy line, or ignoring the emergency tone): the permit is cancelled, the person is banned from all Company land and water for 2 years, and the case is reported to Mae Chaem police station.

Appeals may be made in writing to the Plant Manager within 30 days of the decision.

## 10. Responsibilities and contacts

Ms. Pornthip Wongkhamsing, Community Safety Officer, handles fishing permits, the text alert service, the boat log and complaints from the public. Mr. Wichai Lertpanya, Plant Manager, decides on drone permissions, appeals and any exception to these rules. For emergencies and people in the water, call the Control Room, staffed 24 hours, on 053 828 499. This policy will be reviewed by 30 June 2027.

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